

A short introduction to comparative clauses (of equality)

Antonio Revuelta (Madrid)

antonio.revuelta@uam.es

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2. Scope of the research

- **Clauses and other constituents expressing equality comparison:**

- English: *as*, *like*, ...
- German: *wie*, *als* ...
- Spanish: *como*, ...
- Modern Greek: *όπως* (και), *σαν*, *καθώς* (και), *τόσο* ... *όσο* ...
- Ancient Greek: *ώς*, *ὥσπερ*, *ἄτε*...
- Latin: *ut*, ...

- **Origin**

The original presentation is based on Ancient and Modern Greek data. The examples have been translated into other languages. In case any mistake is noticed, please write to the author.

3. Comparison and other semantic functions

Function	Constituents			
	Subordinate	NP	Adverb	PP
Time	Temporal clauses <i>before you came</i>	the day before	then	before that day
Cause	Cause clauses <i>because you came</i>			<i>due to that, for that reason</i>
Condition	Conditional clauses <i>if/in case you come...</i>		<i>else, then, otherwise</i>	<i>in that case</i>
Concession	Concessive clauses <i>although you came ...</i>		<i>even then</i>	<i>despite ...</i>
Purpose	Purpose clauses <i>for ... to ..., in order to come</i>			<i>for</i>
...	...	...	...	...
? Manner	Comparative clauses <i>as, like¹</i>	?	?	<i>like?</i>

1) Absent from grammars like Rijksbaron 2006 (Ancient Greek)

Problems:

- a) **Semantic function.** In grammars ‘comparison’ is not established as a semantic function in contrast to other functions.
- b) **Alternative expressions.** Although there are some voids, it is possible to enumerate other kinds of constituents displaying the same function as subordinate clauses of Time, Cause, Concession, Purpose, and so on. That is no that easy in the case of comparison clauses.
- c) **Manner.** If we equate comparison of equality with Manner (‘in the X way’), this function does not cover but a minimal part of the range of semantic meanings conveyed by comparative clauses of equality.

Solutions:

- a) Description of their syntactic and semantic scope of action.
- b) Description of the values conveyed by comparative clauses.

4. Syntactic contexts

- (a) Comparatives as a **constituent** of the clause > § 4.1.
- (b) Comparatives as **modifiers** of other constituents > § 4.2.

4.1. Layers of the clause

- Structure of the clause: Dik 1997, Dik *et alii* 1990, Hengeveld 1990.
- Typology of entities: Lyons 1977.

To be honest, probably today I won't properly explain my paper

σ_4

σ_3

σ_2

Arg

σ_1

Arg

SoA (2nd)

Proposition (3rd)

Speech act (4th)

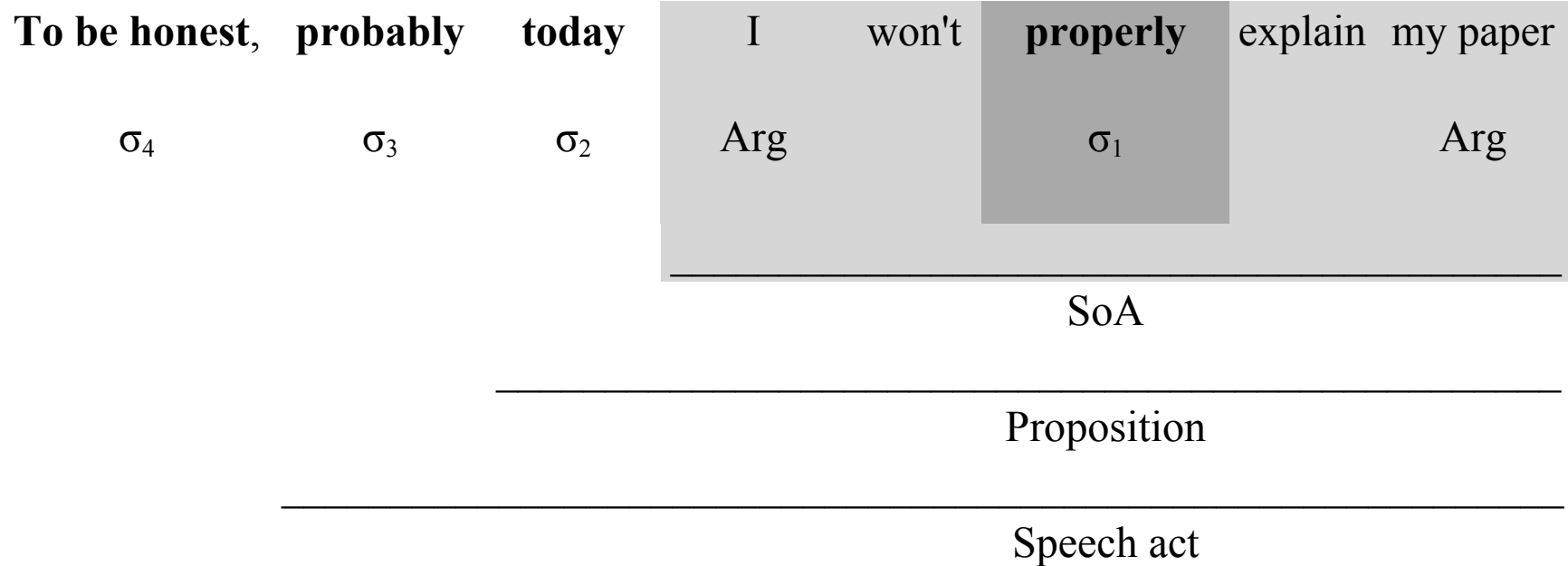


- **Argument/Satellites1 (Adjuncts) of the SoA:**

State of Affairs (SoA)

- a) Something that can happen and be perceived (2nd order entity)
- b) It is described by the verb and the **arguments** and some σ_1 **satellites** (first level adjuncts)

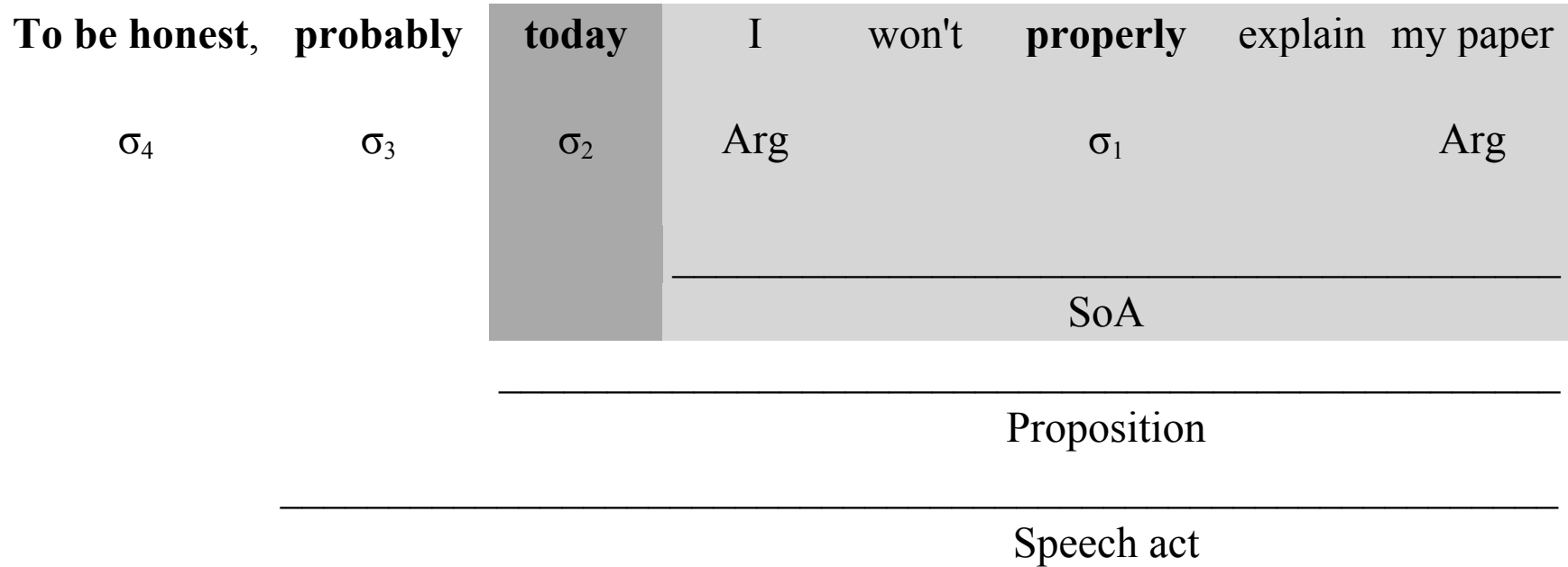
(1) **I won't properly explain my paper**



- **Satellites2/Adjuncts:**

a) That SoA can be placed within a temporal and circumstantial frame by σ_2 **satellites** ($\approx$ second level adjuncts).

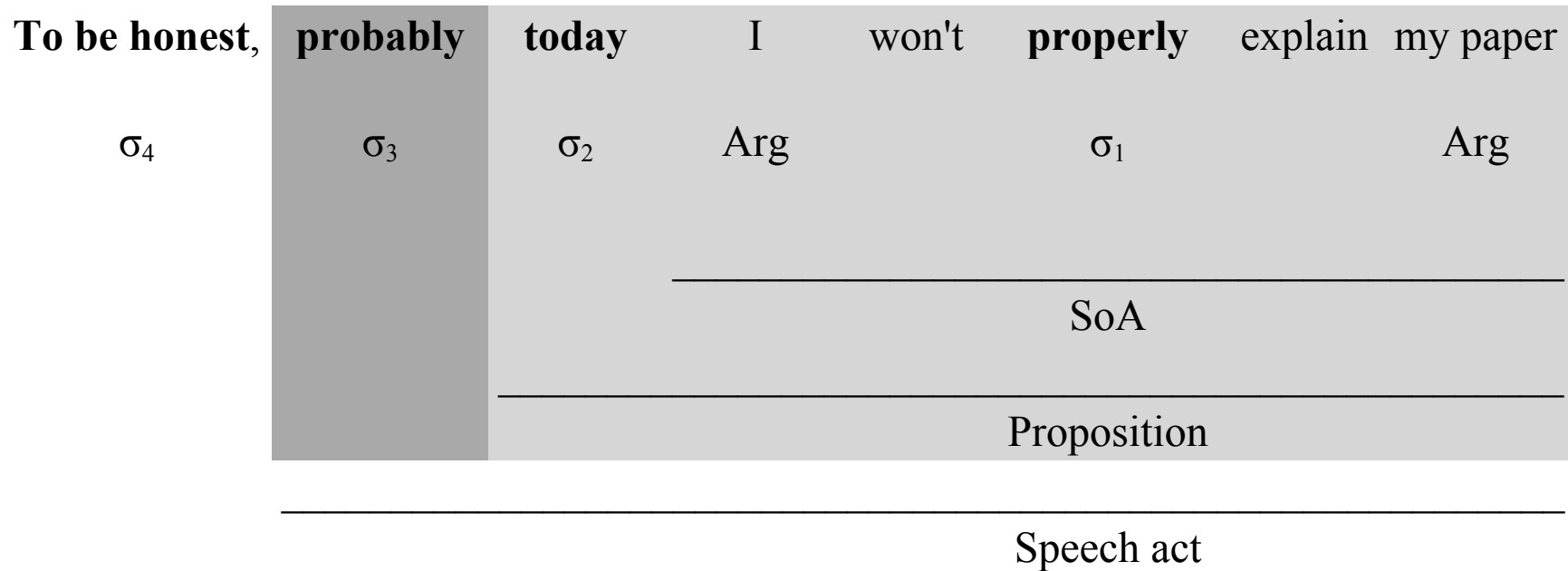
(2) **Today** I won't properly explain my paper



• **Proposition**

- a) Something that can be true, false or uncertain (3rd order entity)
- b) Expressed internally by verb + arguments + σ_1 **satellites** + σ_2 **satellites**
- c) Modified externally by σ_3 **satellites**.

(3) **Probably** today I won't properly explain my paper



- a) The fact that the speaker utters his/her sentence (4th order entity)
- b) Expressed internally by verb + arguments + **$\sigma 1$ satellites** + **$\sigma 2$ satellites** + **$\sigma 3$ satellites**;
- c) Modified externally by **$\sigma 4$ satellites**.

To be honest,	probably	today	I	won't	properly	explain	my paper
σ_4	σ_3	σ_2	Arg		σ_1		Arg
			SoA				
		Proposition					
Speech act							

4.2. Modifier of a NP, Adjective or Adverb.

a1) NP: noun phrase

- (5) a. [A man]_{NP}
b. [A man **like you**]_{NP}

a2) Adj: adjective

- (6) a. The man is [tall]_{Adj}
b. The man is [**as tall as you**]_{Adj}

a3) Adv: adverb

- (7) a. The man drives [slowly]_{Adv}
b. The man drives [**as slowly as you**]_{Adv}

5. Level: clause constituent

5.1. Manner.

5.2. Quality.

5.3. Intensity/degree.

5.4. Progression (?).

5.5. Additive focus.

5.6. Propositional/speech act attitude.

5.7. Discourse connector.

5.8. Minimal pairs.

5.1. Manner

- (8) a. He speaks **as you (do/speak)**¹ (sub. clause)
b. He speaks **well** (adverb)
c. He speaks **in a very formal way** (PP)

Engl.	He speaks as/like you (speak) (sub. clause)
Ger.	Er spricht wie Du (sprichst) (sub. clause)
Sp.	(Él) habla como tú (hablas) (sub. clause)
Mod. Gr.	(Αυτός) μιλάει όπως εσύ (μιλάς) (sub. clause)
Anc. Gr.	(Αὐτὸς) λαλεῖ ὥσπερ σύ (λαλεῖς) (sub. clause)
Lat.	(ille) loquitur ut tu (loqueris) (sub. clause)

Elipsis:

- 1) Elipsis is frequent in **comparative** clauses and **coordinations**.
- 2) Elipsis is more **natural** or **idiomatic** in many cases.

5.1.1. Manner + condition

Engl.	He speaks as if he was right (sub. clause)
Ger.	Er spricht als <u>hätte er</u> recht (sub. clause)
Sp.	(Él) habla como si tuviera razón (sub. clause)
Mod. Gr.	(Αυτός) μιλάει σαν να έχει δίκιο (sub. clause)
Anc. Gr.	(Αὐτός) λαλεῖ ὥσπερ (ἂν) εἰ ὀρθῶς ἔλεγε (sub. clause)
Lat.	(ille) loquitur quasi recte legat (sub. clause)

(i) Elipsis

- (9) a. He speaks **as if** he was right (sub. clause)
- b. ≈ He speaks (under the X conditions) **as** (he would speak) **if** he was right
- c. ≈ He speaks **in the same way as** (he would speak) **if** he was right

Like in coordinations the **common material** is omitted.

(ii) Subordinators:

(10) a. Comparative + conditional:

Engl. *as if*, **Sp.** *como si*, **AG.** ὥσπερ (ἂν) εἰ, **Lat.** *quasi* (*qua* + *si*)

b. Special constructions:

Germ. *als* + inversion, **MG.** σὰν να, λες και.

(iii) Parallel cases with other subordinates

(11) a. I found him very quiet, **as** (I found him) **when** he suffered his first depression

b. Lo encontré muy tranquilo, **como** (lo encontré) **cuando** sufrió su primera depresión.

(12) a. I found him very quiet in Naxos, **as** (I found him quiet) **in Madrid**

b. Lo encontré muy tranquilo en Naxos, **como** (lo encontré muy tranquilo) **en Madrid**.

5.2. Quality

Engl.	He speaks as a lawyer
Ger.	Er spricht als Rechtsanwalt
Sp.	(Él) habla como abogado
Mod. Gr.	(Αυτός) μιλάει ως/(σαν) δικηγόρος
Anc. Gr.	(Αὐτὸς) λαλεῖ ὡς/ᾗτε συνηγόρος
Lat.	(ille) loquitur ut iurisconsultus

(i) Quality (without verb):

- Dik (1997: 231): «Quality satellites designate the role / function / authority by virtue of which an Action is carried out, or a Position maintained; they require [+con] SoAs»

(13) a. He speaks as a lawyer¹

b. ≈ He is a lawyer and he speaks in that quality/role.

Note1: The nominal phrase refers to a **property** and not to an **entity**.

(ii) Quality vs. Manner

- (14) a. He speaks like a lawyer
b. He is **not** a lawyer (probably)
c. $\approx$ He speaks **as a lawyer would speak**.
d. $\approx$ He speaks **in the same way as a lawyer (would speak)**.

Note1: *like* (Manner) vs. *as* (Quality/Manner): Thomson & Martinet (1980³).

(iii) No verbal elipsis: it is not a subordinate clause (Quality)

- (15) a. He speaks **as a lawyer (*speaks)** > Quality
b. He speaks **as/like a lawyer (speaks)** > Manner

Note2: connection between comparative and quality clauses:

comparative expressions > quality expressions

(iv) Means of expression: factors

Lang.	Examples	Funct	Head	Art
English	He speaks as a lawyer	Quality	as	+
	He speaks like a lawyer	Manner	like	+
German	Er spricht als Rechtsanwalt	Quality	als	∅
	Er spricht wie ein Rechtsanwalt (spricht)	Manner	wie	+
Spanish	(Él) habla como abogado	Quality	como	∅
	(Él) habla como un abogado	Manner	como	+
	(Él) trabaja de/como abogado / *habla de abogado	Quality	de	∅
AGreek	(Αὐτὸς) λαλεῖ ὥς συνηγόρος	Quality	ὥς	∅
	(Αὐτὸς) λαλεῖ ὥς συνήγορός (τις) (λαλεῖ)	Manner	ὥς	(+)
	(Αὐτὸς) λαλεῖ ᾗτε συνηγόρος	Quality	ᾗτε	∅
	(Αὐτὸς) λαλεῖ ὥσπερ συνήγορός (τις) (λαλεῖ)	Manner	ὥσπερ	(+)
MGreek	(Αυτός _i) μιλάει ως/(σαν) δικηγόρος _i	Quality	ως/(σαν)	∅
	(Αυτός _i) μιλάει σαν δικηγόρος _i / σαν τον δικηγόρο μου	Manner	σαν	∅
	(Αυτός _i) μιλάει όπως ένας δικηγόρος _i (?)	Manner	όπως	+

a) Difference only in the header: Eng. *as* + *a/like* + *a*

b) Difference: header and article: Germ. *als* *ø/wie* + *ein*.

c) Difference: article (NP = entity or property):

Sp. *como* *ø* /*como* + *un*, AGr *ὥς* *ø* /*ὥς* (*τις*)

(v) Modern Greek

a) AGr *ὥς* (Manner/Quality) > MGr. *ως* ('as', Quality).

b) AGr *ὥς ἄν* > *ὥσάν* > MGr. *σαν*:

b1) 'like' (Manner)

b2) 'as' (Quality): discouraged by prescriptive grammars, but everybody uses it in this way (even those discouraging it)

5.3. Intensity/Degree

Engl.	He speaks as much as you (speak) (sub. clause)
Ger.	Er spricht so viel wie Du (sprichst) (sub. clause)
Sp.	(Él) habla tanto como tú (hablas) (sub. clause)
Mod. Gr.	(Αυτός) μιλάει τόσο όσο εσύ (μιλάς) (sub. clause)
Anc. Gr.	(Αὐτός) λαλεῖ τοσοῦτον ὅσον/οὔτως ὥς σύ (λαλεῖς) (sub. clause)
Lat.	(ille) loquitur tantum quantum tu (loqueris) (sub. clause)

(i) Orientation

(16) a. He eats **as much as** you do

b. He eats **as much food as** you do (object-oriented)

(17) a. He sleeps **as much as** you do

b. He sleeps **as much time as** you do (duration-oriented)

(18) a. He goes to the cinema **as much as** you do

b. He goes to the cinema **as frequently as** you do (frequency-oriented)

(ii) Analysis 1:

Eng. *as much as you*, Germ. *so viel wie Du*

(a) Diachronic analysis:

Adverb (**much**) modified by a comparative clause (**as ... as ...**)

(19) He speaks [as [**much**] as you (speak)]

(b) Synchronic analysis:

Complex subordinator (**as much as**)

(20) He speaks [as much as] you (speak)

(iii) Analysis2:

Sp. *tanto como* ..., MGr. τόσο όσο ..., AGr. τοσοῦτον ὅσον ..., Lat. *tantum quantum*

Relative constructions: adv. + subordinator (rel. adv./conjunction)

(21) a. ¡(Él) habla **tanto**! > Exclamation

b. 'He speaks **so much**!'

(22) a. (Él) habla **tanto como** tú (hablas) > Intensity/Degree

b. 'He speaks **as much as** you'

(23) a. (Él) habla **como** tú (hablas) > Manner

b. 'He speaks **as** you' (well, formally, informally)

5.4. Progression

Engl.	The more he speaks the less I understand	Comp
Ger.	Je mehr er spricht desto weniger verstehe ich	Comp
Sp.	Cuanto más habla (él) menos entiendo yo	Comp
MGr.	Όσο περισσότερο μιλάει (αυτός) τόσο λιγότερο καταλαβαίνω (εγώ)	Comp
Lat.	(ille) quam multissimum loquitur ego tam minimum intellego	Superl
AGr.	(Αὐτὸς) λαλεῖ τοσοῦτω πλεῖον/πλεῖστον ὅσω ἐλάσσον/ἐλάχιστον συνίημι	Comp/ Super

(i) **Subordinate character:** rather than a main and subordinate clause, there seems to exist a complex construction (coordination).

(ii) **Causal connection:** inversion of the terms changes the sense:

- (24) a. **The more** he speaks (cause) **the less** I understand (effect)
b. $\neq$ **The less** I understand (cause) **the more** he speaks (effect)

5.5. Additive focus

Engl.	Like <u>the rapporteur</u> , I deplore the fact that the figures given in the report do not cover all state aid.
Ger.	Ebenso wie <u>der Berichterstatter</u> bedaure auch ich, daß die in dem Berichtenthaltenen Zahlen nicht alle staatlichen Beihilfen abdecken.
Sp.	Deploro, al igual que <u>el ponente</u> , que las cifras presentadas en el informe no cubran todas las ayudas estatales.

(i) Additive Focus vs. Manner (Revuelta: 2020)

(25) **Like the rapporteur**, I deplore the fact that [...]

a.≠ **I** deplore the fact that ... **in the same way** as the **rapporteur**

> We both do something **in the same way** (**Manner**)

b. ≈ **I** deplore the fact that ... and the **rapporteur** deplores it too

> We both **do the same**: we deplore the fact that [...] (**Additive focus**)

(ii) Additive Focus vs. Coordination: presupposition and assertion

(26) **I and the rapporteur** deplore the fact that the figures given in the report do not cover all state aid.

a. **I** deplore the fact that the figures ... (**assertion**)

b. **The rapporteur** deplores the fact that the figures ... (**assertion**)

(27) **Like the rapporteur**, I deplore the fact that the figures given in the report do not cover all state aid.

a. **I** deplore the fact that the figures ... (**assertion**)

b. **The rapporteur** deplores the fact that the figures ... (**presupposition**)

(iii) Similitude with so-called Focusing particles

König (1991)

(28) **Like the rapporteur, I** deplore the fact that the figures given in the report do not cover all state aid.

a. **I** deplore the fact that the figures ... (**assertion**)

b. **The rapporteur** deplores the fact that the figures ... (**presupposition**)

(29) **I** deplore **too** the fact that the figures given in the report do not cover all state aid.

a. **I** deplore the fact that the figures ... (**assertion**)

b. **Someone (≠ I)** deplores the fact that the figures ... (**presupposition**)

Note1: Both constructions introduce a presupposition for alternative (sets of) entities: the subordinate identifies that entity, while the adverb keeps it unidentified.

(iv) **Harmonic constructions:** comparative + additive focus adverb

as ... too ..., wie ... auch ...

- (30) Ebenso **wie** der Berichtstatter bedaure **auch** ich, daß die in dem Berichtenthaltenen Zahlen nicht alle staatlichen Beihilfen abdecken. (sub. clause?)
- a. Ich bedaure, daß ... (**assertion**)
- b. Der Berichtstatter bedauert, daß ... (**presupposition**)
- (31) Η κ. Παπανδρέου, **όπως και ο πρωθυπουργός**, μίλησε για τα πολλά δισεκατομμύρια που έχει πληρώσει ο ελληνικός λαός στις ΔΕΚΟ. («Mrs. Papandreou, **like** the prime minister, spoke about the many billions that the Greek people have paid to DEKO.», ILSP 1263124)
- (32) **ὥσπερ** δὲ ἡ γῆ, **οὕτω καὶ ἡ περὶ τὴν χώραν θάλαττα παμφορωτάτη ἐστίν («As productive as the land is too the sea around the coasts.», X. Vect. 1.3).**

(v) Development: from comparative (focus) into coordination

- (33) a. Εμείς έχουμε την υποχρέωση να συμμετέχουμε στην εκπόνηση των κατευθυντήριων γραμμών, **καθώς και** στην αξιολόγηση των αποτελεσμάτων.
- b. We are obliged to participate in drafting directives **and also** in assessing their results.
- c. Nosotros tenemos la obligación de participar en la elaboración de las directrices **y también** en la evaluación de los resultados.

Language	Comparative conjunction	Coordinating conjunction
English	as	A ... as well as ... B
German	wie	A ... sowohl ... als auch ... B
Spanish	como	A ... tanto ... como ... B A ... así como ... B
MGreek	όσο	A ... τόσο ... όσο ... B A ... καθώς και ... B A ... όπως και ... B

5.6. Propositional/Speech act attitude

Quirk et alii (1985: 1112-1118): ‘comment clauses’

English	As Peter says , you should never believe lawyers
German	Wie Peter sagt , <u>Du solltest/solltest Du</u> keinen Rechtsanwälten glauben (sub. clause? > no inversion)
Spanish	Como Pedro dice , no debes creer a los abogados
MGreek	Όπως λέει ο Πέτρος , δε θα έπρεπε να πιστέψεις τους δικηγόρους
AGreek	ὥς/ὥσπερ λέγει ὁ Πέτρος , συνηγόροις σε οὐ δεῖ πιστεύειν
Latin	ut Petrus dicit , non decet iurisconsultis credere

Paraphrase: the subordinate says that the content conveyed by the main clause belongs to the things Peter says.

(i) Differences with Manner

(34) **As Peter says**, you should never believe lawyers

- a. $\approx$ **According to Peter/In Peter's opinion** you should never believe lawyers
(Propositional Attitude)
- b. $\neq$ You should never believe lawyers **in the way Peter says (you should believe them)**
(Manner)

(ii) Scope

It is not a constituent of the main clause (predication), but takes the sentence (proposition) as a predicate (it is its logical object/subject)

(35) **As Peter says**, you should never believe lawyers

- c. **Peter says** that you should never believe lawyers

5.7. Discourse level

(36) **As I was saying, ...**

- Some comparative clauses refer to the **speaker's own words**.
- They constitute **metalinguistic remarks** on the speaker's speech that help the addressee to **process** the information from a discursive perspective: the comparative clauses inform the addressee how a discursive unit fits into the general structure.
- Very frequently the comparative clause informs the hearer that the speaker is **coming back** to the **main thread** of his/her discourse.
- Before the unit commented by the comparative clause **excursus** or **digressions** appear.

• Passage taken from Plutarch's life of Dion

- Plutarch's life of Dion describes the life of Dion of Syracuse (408-354 BC), brother in law of Dionysus I (402-367 BC) and his son Dionysius II (397-343 BC), tyrants of Syracuse (Sicily).
- He was a Platonist who invited Plato to Syracuse in his efforts of making the tyrants into philosophers and creating a better political system in his city.
- Plato travelled to Sicily three times (387, 366, 361 BC).
- The passage describes the situation before Plato's second trip: Dionysus I has already died.
- Dion is respected at the court (he was very wealthy, capable and had very good connections with the Carthaginians), but is not popular and was more feared than loved by Dionysius II.

(37) 10. τὸν δ' υἱὸν αὐτοῦ, **καθάπερ εἴρηται**, διαλελωβημένον ἀπαιδευσία καὶ συντετριμμένον τὸ ἦθος ὁ Δίων ὁρῶν παρεκάλει πρὸς παιδείαν τραπέσθαι καὶ δεηθῆναι τοῦ πρώτου τῶν φιλοσόφων πᾶσαν δέησιν ἐλθεῖν εἰς Σικελίαν· («This tyrant's son, **as I have said**, Dion saw to be dwarfed and deformed in character from his lack of education, and therefore exhorted him to apply himself to study, and to use every entreaty with the first of philosophers to come to Sicily», Plut. *Dion* 10.1)

Dion attributes his problems with Dionysus II to his lack of education αἰτίαν δὲ τούτου τὴν ἀπαιδευσίαν εἶναι νομίζων ἐμβαλεῖν αὐτὸν εἰς διατριβὰς ἐλευθερίους ἐφιλοτιμεῖτο καὶ γεῦσαι λόγων καὶ μαθημάτων ἡθοποιῶν, ὡς ἀρετὴν τε παύσαιτο δεδιὼς καὶ τοῖς καλοῖς χαίρειν ἐθισθεῖν. Considering, then, that a reason for this lay in the tyrant's want of education, he sought to engage him in liberal studies, and to give him a taste of such literature and science as formed the character, in order that he might cease to be afraid of virtue, and become accustomed to take delight in what was high and noble.

Dionysus I deprived his son of education φύσει γὰρ οὐ γέγονει τῶν φαυλοτάτων τυράννων ὁ Διονύσιος, ἀλλ' ὁ πατήρ, δεδοικώς μὴ φρονήματος μεταλαβὼν καὶ συγγενόμενος νοῦν ἔχουσιν ἀνθρώποις ἐπιβουλεύσειεν αὐτῷ καὶ παρέλοιτο τὴν ἀρχήν, ἐφρούρει κατὰ κλειστον οἶκοι, δι' ἐρημίαν ὁμιλίας ἐτέρας καὶ ἀπειρίᾳ πραγμάτων, ὡς φασιν, ἀμάξια καὶ λυχνίας καὶ δίφρους ξυλίνους καὶ τραπέζας τεκταινόμενον. For by nature Dionysius did not belong to the worst class of tyrants, but his father, fearing that if he should get wisdom and associate with men of sense, he would plot against him and rob him of his power, used to keep him closely shut up at home, where, through lack of association with others and in ignorance of affairs, as we are told, he made little waggons and lampstands and wooden chairs and tables.

Dionysus I suspected everybody: his barber had to use fire instead of scissors οὕτω γὰρ ἦν ἄπιστος καὶ πρὸς ἅπαντας ἀνθρώπους ὑποπτος καὶ προβεβλημένος διὰ φόβον ὁ πρεσβύτερος Διονύσιος ὥστε μὴδὲ τῆς κεφαλῆς τὰς τρίχας ἀφελεῖν[*] κουρικαῖς μαχαίραις, ἀλλὰ τῶν πλαστῶν τις ἐπιφοιτῶν ἄνθρακι τὴν κόμην περιέκαιεν. For the elder Dionysius was so distrustful and suspicious towards every body, and his fear led him to be so much on his guard, that he would not even have his hair cut with barbers' scissors, but a hairdresser would come and singe his locks with a live coal.

Everybody had to be naked before visiting him εἰσῆει δὲ πρὸς αὐτὸν εἰς τὸ δωμάτιον οὔτε ἀδελφὸς οὔθ' υἱὸς ὡς ἔτυχεν ἡμφιεσμένος, ἀλλ' ἔδει πρὶν εἰσελθεῖν ἀποδύντα τὴν ἑαυτοῦ στολὴν ἕκαστον ἐτέραν ἀναλαβεῖν, ὁραθέντα γυμνὸν ὑπὸ τῶν φυλαττόντων. Neither his brother nor his son could visit him in his apartment wearing any clothes they pleased, but every one had to take off his own apparel before entering and put on another, after the guards had seen him stripped.

Dionysus I killed a body-guard for lending a spear to his own brother ἐπεὶ δὲ Λεπτίνης ὁ ἀδελφὸς αὐτῷ ποτε χωρίου φύσιν ἐξηγούμενος λαβὼν λόγχην παρὰ τινος τῶν δορυφόρων υπέγραψε τὸν τόπον, ἐκείνῳ μὲν ἰσχυρῶς ἐχαλέπηνε, τὸν δὲ δόντα τὴν λόγχην ἀπέκτεινε. And once, when his brother Leptines was describing to him the nature of a place, and drew the plan of it on the ground with a spear which he took from one of his body-guards, he was extremely angry with him, and had the man who gave him the spear put to death.

Dionysus I suspected even his own friends ἔλεγε δὲ τοὺς φίλους φυλάττεσθαι νοῦν ἔχοντας εἰδὼς καὶ βουλομένους μᾶλλον τυραννεῖν ἢ τυραννεῖσθαι. He used to say, too, that he was on his guard against his friends who were men of sense, because he knew that they would rather be tyrants than subjects of a tyrant.

Dionysus I killed Marsyas because he saw himself in dreams killing the tyrant καὶ Μαρσύαν δὲ τινὰ τῶν προηγμένων ὑπ' αὐτοῦ καὶ τεταγμένων ἐφ' ἡγεμονίας ἀνείλε δόξαντα κατὰ τοὺς ὕπνους σφάττειν αὐτόν, ὡς ἀπ' ἐννοίας μεθμερινῆς καὶ διαλογισμοῦ τῆς ὄψεως ταύτης εἰς τὸν ὕπνον αὐτῷ παραγενομένης. And he slew Marsyas, one of those whom he had advanced to positions of high command, for having dreamed that he killed him, declaring that this vision must have visited his sleep because in his waking hours he had purposed and planned such a deed.

Despite being like that Dionysus I was angry with Plato for not considering him the bravest of men ὁ μὲν δὲ Πλάτῳ θυμωθεὶς ὅτι μὴ πάντων αὐτὸν ἀνθρώπων ἀνδρείοτατον ὄντα ἀπέφηνεν, οὕτω περίφοβον καὶ τοσοῦτον ὑπὸ δειλίας κακῶν μεστὴν εἶχε τὴν ψυχὴν. Yes, the man who was angry with Plato because he would not pronounce him the most valiant man alive, had a spirit as timorous as this, and so full of all the evils induced by cowardice.

Dion saw Dionysius' state and tries to educate him 10. τὸν δ' υἱὸν αὐτοῦ, καθάπερ εἴρηται, διαλεωβημένον ἀπαιδευσίᾳ καὶ συντετριμμένον τὸ ἦθος ὁ Δίων ὁρῶν παρεκάλει πρὸς παιδείαν τραπέσθαι καὶ δεηθῆναι τοῦ πρώτου τῶν φιλοσόφων πᾶσαν δέησιν ἐλθεῖν εἰς Σικελίαν. 10. This tyrant's son, as I have said, Dion saw to be dwarfed and deformed in character from his lack of education, and therefore exhorted him to apply himself to study, and to use every entreaty with the first of philosophers to come to Sicily

Dion attributes his problems with Dionysus II to his lack of education. Considering, then, that a reason for this lay in **the tyrant's want of education**, he sought to engage him in liberal studies, and to give him a taste of such literature and science as formed the character, in order that he might cease to be afraid of virtue, and become accustomed to take delight in what was high and noble.

Dionysus I deprived his son of education. For by nature Dionysius did not belong to the worst class of tyrants, but his father, fearing that if he should get wisdom and associate with men of sense, he would plot against him and rob him of his power, used to keep him closely shut up at home, where, through lack of association with others and in ignorance of affairs, as we are told, he made little waggons and lampstands and wooden chairs and tables.

Dionysus I suspected everybody: his barber had to use fire instead of scissors. For the elder Dionysius was so distrustful and suspicious towards every body, and his fear led him to be so much on his guard, that he would not even have his hair cut with barbers' scissors, but a hairdresser would come and singe his locks with a live coal.

Everybody had to be naked before visiting him. Neither his brother nor his son could visit him in his apartment wearing any clothes they pleased, but every one had to take off his own apparel before entering and put on another, after the guards had seen him stripped.

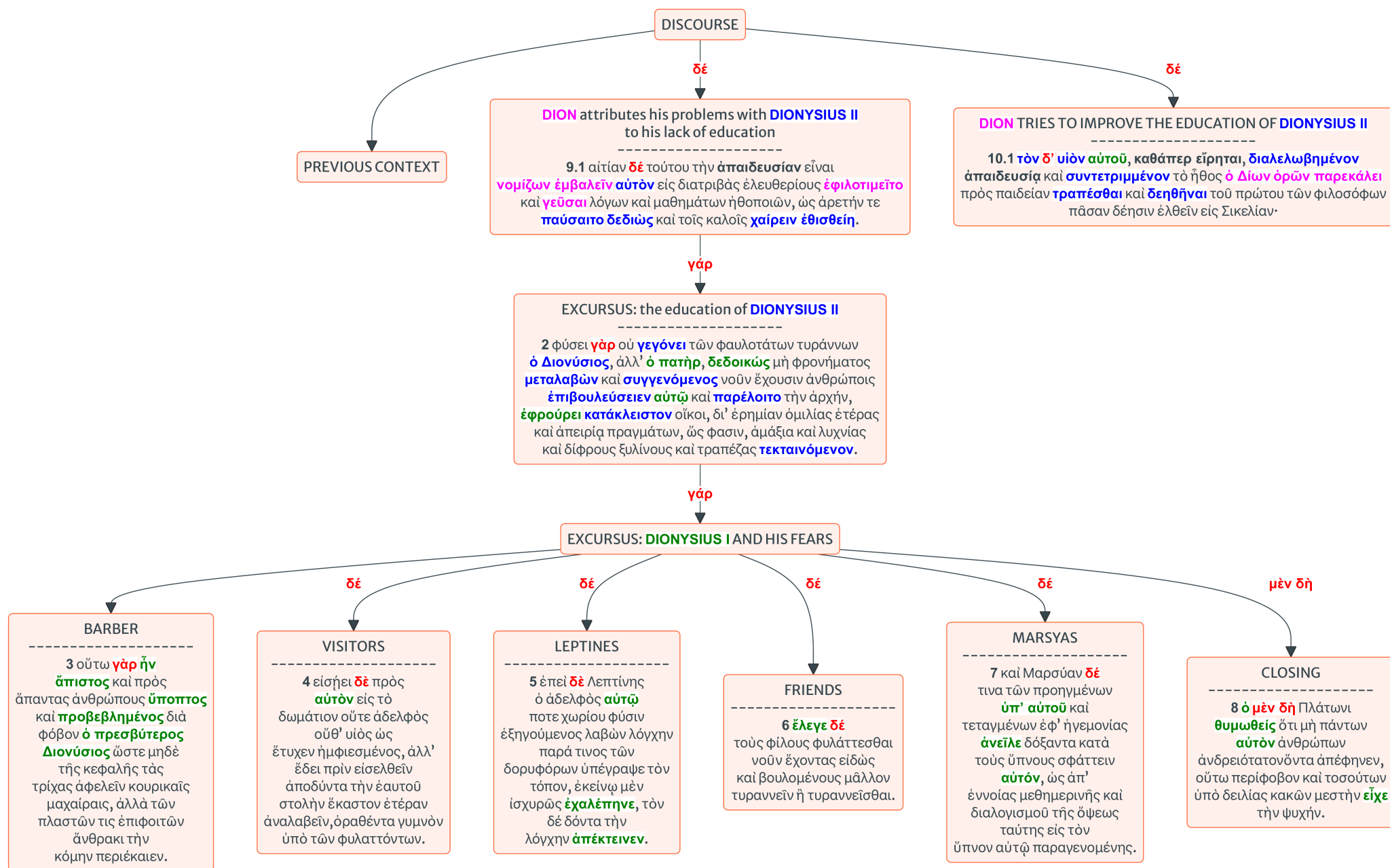
Dionysus I killed a body-guard for lending a spear to his own brother. And once, when his brother Leptines was describing to him the nature of a place, and drew the plan of it on the ground with a spear which he took from one of his body-guards, he was extremely angry with him, and had the man who gave him the spear put to death.

Dionysus I suspected even his own friends. He used to say, too, that he was on his guard against his friends who were men of sense, because he knew that they would rather be tyrants than subjects of a tyrant.

Dionysus I killed Marsyas because he saw himself in dreams killing the tyrant. And he slew Marsyas, one of those whom he had advanced to positions of high command, for having dreamed that he killed him, declaring that this vision must have visited his sleep because in his waking hours he had purposed and planned such a deed.

Despite being like that Dionysus I was angry with Plato for not considering him the bravest of men. Yes, the man who was angry with Plato because he would not pronounce him the most valiant man alive, had a spirit as timorous as this, and so full of all the evils induced by cowardice.

Dion saw Dionysius' state and tries to educate him. 10. This tyrant's son, **as I have said**, Dion saw to be dwarfed and deformed in character from **his lack of education**, and therefore exhorted him to apply himself to study, and to use every entreaty with the first of philosophers to come to Sicily.



Discursive analysis of Plutarch's life of Dion

5.8. Clause level: minimal pairs

(38) a. Peter spoke **as we expected** (**Manner**).

(= Peter spoke and he did so **in the way we expected** him to speak).

b. **As we expected**, Peter spoke (**Propositional Attitude**).

(= **We expected that** Peter would speak and he did so).

c. Peter spoke, **as we expected** (**Propositional Attitude**).

(39) a. Peter worked **as/like the doorman** (**Manner/Degree**).

(= Peter worked **in the same way/with the same intensity** as the doorman).

b. Peter worked **as a doorman** (**Quality**).

(= Peter was a doorman and he worked **in that quality/role**).

(40) a. Peter spoke yesterday **like John** (Manner).

(= Peter spoke yesterday and he did so **in the same way as John**).

b. Peter — **like John** — spoke yesterday (Additive Focus).

(= Peter spoke yesterday **and** John did so **too**).

(41) a. Peter spoke yesterday **as I told you before** (Manner).

(= Peter spoke yesterday and he did so **in the way I told you** before he did).

b. **As I told you before**, Peter spoke yesterday (Speech attitude).

(= **I have told you** this before **that** Peter spoke yesterday).

6. Level: NP modifiers

Comparative clauses can modified the internal structure of NP

Engl.	A man like you (are) (sub. clause)
Ger.	Ein Mann wie Du (bist) (sub. clause)
Sp.	Un hombre como tú (eres) (sub. clause)

(i) Features:

- a) The NP may refer to an entity or to a set of entities (generic meaning).
- b) The entity or the set exhibits the same qualities as the entity headed by the comparative clauses:

(42) a. A man like you

b. $\approx$ Any man/all men **who is/are like you**

(ii) Equivalence to other NP modifiers

- (43) a. [A man **like you** (are)] shouldn't behave that way (**comp. clause**)
b. [An **educated** man] shouldn't behave that way (**adj.**)
c. [A man **who is educated**] shouldn't behave that way (**rel. clause**)
d. [A man **of your education**] shouldn't behave that way (**PP**)

(iii) Exceptions:

Quality/Class relative clauses:

qualis and *οἷος* agree in case, gender and number with a NP of the subordinate clause (tu and σύ)

Latin	vir (talis) qualis _i tu _i (es) 'a man like you'
Ancient Greek	ἄνθρωπος (τοιούτου) οἷος _i σύ _i (εἶ) 'a man like you'

(iv) Other syntactic positions

Engl.	He is intelligent	(adj. attributive)
	He is like you (are)	(sub. clause)
Ger.	Er is klug	(adj. attributive)
	Er is wie Du (bist)	(sub. clause)
Sp.	(Él) es listo	(adj. attributive)
	(Él) es como tú (eres)	(sub. clause)

(v) Conclusion:

Comparative clauses can be used to adscribe **properties** to Nouns or NP: they operate as restrictors or modifiers.

7. Level: Adjectival modifiers

Engl.	He is as <u>tall</u> as you (are)
Ger.	Er ist so <u>groß</u> wie Du (bist)
Sp.	(Él) es tan <u>alto</u> como tú (eres)
Mod. Gr.	(Αυτός) είναι τόσο <u>ψηλός</u> όσο εσύ (είσαι)
Anc. Gr.	(Αὐτός) ἔστι οὕτως <u>μέγας</u> ὥς σύ (εἶ)
Lat.	(ille) est ita <u>longus</u> ut tu (es)

(44) a. He is tall (positive degree)

b. He is [**as tall as you (are)**] (**comparison, equality**)

c. He is [**taller than you (are)**] (comparison, superiority)

d. He is [**less tall than you (are)**] (comparison, inferiority)

e. He is [**very tall**] (superlative absolute)

e. He is [**the tallest**] (superlative relative)

8. Level: Adverbial modifiers

Engl.	He speaks as <u>fast</u> as you (speak)
Ger.	Er spricht so <u>schnell</u> wie Du (sprichst)
Sp.	(Él) habla tan <u>deprisa</u> como tú (hablas)
Mod. Gr.	(Αυτός) μιλάει τόσο <u>γρήγορα</u> όσο εσύ (μιλάς)
Anc. Gr.	(Αὐτός) λαλεῖ οὕτως <u>ταχέως</u> ὥς σὺ (λαλεῖς)
Lat.	(ille) loquitur ita <u>celeriter</u> ut tu (loqueris)

(45) a. He speaks fast (positive grade)

b. He speaks [**as fast as you (speak)**] (**comparison, equality**)

c. He speaks [**faster than you (speak)**] (comparison, superiority)

d. He speaks [**less fast than you (speak)**] (comparison, inferiority)

e. He speaks [**very fast**] (superlative)

9. Diachronic developments

A) Comparatives (focus) > (heavy) coordination

Language	Comparative conjunction	Coordinative conjunction
English	as	A ... as well as ... B
German	wie	sowohl A ... als auch ... B
Spanish	como	tanto A ... como ... B A ... así como ... B
MGreek	όσο	τόσο A ... όσο ... B A ... καθώς και B A ... όπως και B

(i) Common features: elipsis

(ii) Differences:

- Coordination: only assertion
- Comparative clauses: assertion + presupposition

B) Comparatives > Additive focusing expressions

(i) Spanish: *también* ‘too’

(46) Pedro habla **tan bien como** su padre (‘Pedro speaks **as well as** his father’)

a. **Pedro** speaks (**assertion**)

b. **His father** speaks (**presupposition**)

c. Both speak in the same way (**Manner**)

(47) **También** Pedro habla (‘Pedro speaks too’)

a. **Pedro** speaks (**assertion**)

b. **Somebody** ($\neq$ **Pedro**) speaks (**presupposition**)

(ii) Spanish: *tampoco* ‘not either’

(48) Pedro habla **tan poco como** su padre (‘Pedro speaks **as little as** his father’)

- a. **Pedro** speaks **very little** (**assertion**)
- b. **His father** speaks **very little** (**presupposition**)
- c. Both speak in the same degree/frequency (**Degree**)

(49) **Tampoco** Pedro habla (‘Pedro **doesn't** speaks either’)

- a. **Pedro doesn't** speak (**assertion**)
- b. **Somebody** ($\neq$ **Pedro**) **doesn't** speak (**presupposition**)

C) Comparatives > Coordination/Additive focusing

(i) English

(50) I have to feed the animals **as well as** look after the children. (Swan § 91.4)

(**Coordination**)

(51) **As well as** learning to swim he has been taking Spanish lessons this summer (Quirk *et alii* 1985: 708)

(**Additive PP** ≈ ‘in addition to’, ‘apart from’)

(52) We bought <some beer> **as well** (Quirk *et alii* 1985: 604)

(**Additive adverb**)

10. Synoptic view

LEVEL		FUNCTIONS	ENGLISH	GERMAN	LATIN	SPANISH	AGREEK	MGREEK
Clause	Arg/σ1	Manner	like a lawyer	wie ein	ut	como	ὥσπερ/ὥς	σαν+Ac.
		Manner+Cond.	as if...	als+inver	quasi	como si	ὥσπερ εἰ	σαν να
		Intensity/Degree	as much as	so viel wie	tantum quantum	tanto como	τοσοῦτον ὅσον	τόσο ὅσο
		Quality	as a lawyer	als ...	ut	como	ὥς/ἄτε	ως/σαν
	σ2/σ3	Additive focus	like ... (too)	wie ... (auch)	ut... (etiam)	como ... (también)	ὥσπερ (καί)	καθώς και
	σ3	Proposition	as	wie	ut	como	ὥσπερ/ὥς	όπως
	σ3/σ4	Speech attitude/ Discourse	as	wie	ut	como	ὥσπερ/ὥς	όπως
?	?	Progression	the more ... the more ...	je ... desto ...	quam superl. ... tam superl. ...	cuanto ... tanto ...	τοσοῦτω... τοιούτω ...	τόσο ... ὅσο ...
Diachr Evolut	Coord	Copulative	...as well as...	sowohl... als auch...	sic ... ut ...	tanto... como...	(καί) ... ὥσπερ (καί)...	καθώς και
	Focus	Additive	...as well as...			también		
NP		Modifier	like	wie	(talis) ... qualis ...	como	τοιούτος ... οἷος...	σαν+Ac.
Adj/Adv		Equality degree	as ... as ...	so ... wie ...	sic ... ut ...	tan ... como ...	οὕτως ...ὥσπερ...	τόσο ... ὅσο...

Conclusions:

- 1) **‘Comparative clause’** isn't a linguistic label parallel to those applied to other subordinate clauses (temporal, causal, conditional, purpose, and so on). ‘Comparison’ doesn't refer to any semantic function (SF) used to classify other type of constituents: adverbs, noun phrases, prepositional phrases.
- 2) So-called **‘Comparative clauses’** can fulfill many different semantic functions and exhibit other values not always clearly classified.
- 3) From a diachronic point of view **comparative clauses** can develop into **coordinating conjunctions** and **additive focus particles**

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Some general piece of advice:

- 1) Compare as many languages as possible: sometimes a language gives you the clue for understanding others.
- 2) Read so as to have a general frame and organize all phenomena: finding a place for each linguistic phenomenon.
- 3) Read on a certain topic following a path of complexity:
 - a) First thinner books, later dicker books.
 - b) First easy books, later more difficult books.
- 4) Mackridge's grammar of Modern Greek.